# Advanced Viva Insights — Collaboration Analysis Guide

Using the Advanced Analysis Workbench for Workplace Collaboration Patterns Beyond Copilot

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## 1. Purpose

This guide covers using Viva Insights Advanced Analysis to understand workplace collaboration patterns **beyond Copilot**. The same analyst workbench, the same org data, the same privacy settings, and the same Power BI workflow — but with different metrics and templates focused on meetings, focus time, wellbeing, and manager effectiveness.

Collaboration analysis provides the organisational context that makes Copilot impact data meaningful. Without understanding baseline collaboration patterns, it is impossible to measure whether Copilot is genuinely improving how people work.

## 2. Relationship to Copilot Analytics

Collaboration analysis and Copilot analytics share the same infrastructure. Understanding their relationship helps analysts maximise both capabilities.

| Aspect | Copilot Analytics | Collaboration Analysis |
|---|---|---|
| Role required | Insights Analyst | Insights Analyst (same role) |
| Org data | Shared org data upload | Same org data — carries over automatically |
| Privacy settings | Shared privacy configuration | Same privacy settings apply |
| Partitions | Configured per agency/BU | Same partitions carry over |
| Metrics focus | Copilot adoption, usage, impact, sentiment | Collaboration time, meeting patterns, focus time, after-hours, wellbeing |
| Data retention | Up to 13 months | Up to 27 months |
| Power BI workflow | Download .pbit → paste IDs → Load | Same workflow |
| Can run simultaneously | Yes — no conflict. Both query types can be active concurrently. | |

> **Key Insight:** If you have already configured org data, partitions, and privacy settings for Copilot Analytics, you can start running collaboration queries immediately with no additional setup.

## 3. Available Collaboration Templates

Viva Insights provides pre-built Power BI templates for common collaboration analysis scenarios. Each template includes predefined metrics, visualisations, and narrative guidance.

| Template | Analysis Focus | Key Questions Answered |
|---|---|---|
| **Ways of Working** | Collaboration patterns, meeting effectiveness, wellbeing, coaching | How much time do employees spend in digital collaboration? Is meeting time effective? Do employees get sufficient focus time? Are managers coaching their teams? |
| **Meeting Effectiveness** | Meeting culture — duration, frequency, overlap, multitasking | Are meetings too long? Too frequent? Do employees multitask during meetings? How much time is spent in recurring vs. ad-hoc meetings? |
| **Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility** | Focus time, work-life balance, urgency, flexible schedules, breaks, community | Are employees working after hours? Do they have enough focus time? Are schedules flexible? Do employees take breaks and connect with colleagues? |
| **Impact Explorer** | Impact estimation of Viva Insights actions | Did meeting reduction initiatives save time? Did focus time protection improve productivity? What is the estimated impact of behavioural nudges? |
| **Manager Effectiveness** | Manager 1:1 time, team collaboration, span of control | Are managers spending enough 1:1 time with direct reports? What is the typical span of control? How do team collaboration patterns vary by manager? |
| **External Collaboration** | Collaboration with external contacts — meetings, email, chat | How much time is spent collaborating with external parties? Which teams have the most external interaction? What channels are used? |

## Template References

- Ways of Working
- Meeting Effectiveness
- Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility
- Impact Explorer

- Manager Effectiveness
- External Collaboration

## 4. Key Behavioural Metrics

The following table groups the core behavioural metrics available for collaboration analysis. These metrics can be used in templates, custom queries, and filters.

| Category | Metrics |
|---|---|
| **Meeting Hours** | Meeting hours, recurring meeting hours, conflicting meeting hours, multitasking meeting hours, long meeting hours, large meeting hours |
| **Focus Time** | Focus hours, uninterrupted focus hours, booked focus hours (via Viva Insights focus plan) |
| **After-Hours** | After-hours collaboration hours, after-hours meeting hours, after-hours email hours, after-hours chat hours |
| **Email** | Email hours, emails sent, emails read |
| **Chat & Calls** | Chat hours, chats sent, call hours, calls made |
| **Manager Interaction** | Manager 1:1 meeting hours, manager co-attendance hours |
| **Collaboration Scope** | Internal collaboration hours, external collaboration hours, cross-group collaboration hours, network size |

> **Metric Tip:** "Multitasking meeting hours" captures time in meetings where the employee was also actively sending emails or chats — a strong indicator of meeting overload or low meeting relevance.

**Reference:** Viva Insights Metric Definitions

## 5. Custom Query Capabilities

Beyond the pre-built templates, analysts can create fully custom queries with tailored metrics, filters, and groupings.

### Custom Metric Features

- Filter metrics by day of week (e.g., meeting hours on Fridays only)
- Filter by meeting duration (e.g., meetings longer than 60 minutes)
- Filter by attendee count (e.g., meetings with more than 10 attendees)
- Filter by organisational attributes from org data (e.g., department, location, level)
- Clone existing metrics and modify filters for tailored analysis

### Copilot Assistant

The Viva Insights analyst workbench includes a Copilot assistant that can help you choose appropriate metrics and filters based on your analysis goals. Describe what you want to measure, and the assistant will suggest relevant metrics and configurations.

> **Power User Tip:** Clone a standard metric (e.g., "Meeting hours"), then add a filter for "recurring = true" and "duration > 60 minutes" to create a metric that specifically captures time in long recurring meetings — a common target for optimisation.

**Reference:** Custom Metrics in Viva Insights

## 6. Prerequisites

The prerequisites for collaboration analysis are the same as for Copilot Analytics. If you have already set up the Copilot Analytics environment, no additional configuration is required.

| Requirement | Details |
|---|---|
| **Role** | Insights Analyst role assigned in the Microsoft 365 Admin Center |
| **Licences** | 50+ Viva Insights licences (included with Microsoft 365 Copilot licence) |
| **Power BI Desktop** | December 2022 release or later |
| **Org Data** | Uploaded via Viva Insights admin settings (CSV or Azure AD sync) |
| **Behavioural Insights** | Enabled via VFAM: `TenantPolicyForBehavioralExperiences = ON`. This is a tenant-level setting that must be enabled by a Global Administrator. |

> **Note:** If `TenantPolicyForBehavioralExperiences` is set to OFF, no behavioural metrics (meeting hours, focus time, etc.) will be available — for either Copilot or collaboration queries. This is the single most common blocker for new deployments.

## 7. How to Create a Collaboration Report

The workflow for creating a collaboration report follows the same pattern as Copilot Analytics templates. If you have created a Copilot query before, this process will be familiar.

1. Sign in to analysis.insights.viva.office.com with your Insights Analyst account.
2. Select **Create analysis** from the left navigation, then choose **Templates**.
3. Select a collaboration template — for example, **Ways of Working**.
4. Configure the query:
   - 5 **Name:** Give it a descriptive name (e.g., "Q1 2026 Ways of Working – All Agencies")
   - 6 **Time period:** Select the analysis window — collaboration data supports up to 27 months
   - 7 **Auto-refresh:** Enable if you want the query to re-run automatically on a schedule
8. Review the predefined metrics included in the template. Optionally add custom metrics using the **Add metric** button.

9. Set employee filters to scope the analysis (e.g., specific departments, locations, or levels). Select which org attributes to include in the output for grouping.
10. Select **Run** to execute the query. Processing time depends on population size and time period — typically 30 minutes to several hours.
11. Once complete, download the **.pbit** file (Power BI template) from the query results page.
12. Open the .pbit file in Power BI Desktop. When prompted, paste the **Partition ID** and **Query ID** from the Viva Insights results page. Select **Load**.
13. Explore the report — navigate through the pre-built pages, apply filters, and customise visualisations as needed.
14. To share with leadership, use the **Publish Reports** feature in Viva Insights to push a read-only version to authorised viewers.

> **Time-Saver:** If you have an existing Copilot query with org attributes and filters configured, you can use the same setup for your collaboration query — just select a different template. No need to reconfigure org data or privacy settings.

## 8. Common Use Cases

### Scenario 1: Meeting Culture Audit

**Template:** Meeting Effectiveness

**Goal:** Identify meeting overload, long recurring meetings, and multitasking patterns across the organisation.

**Approach:**

1. Run the Meeting Effectiveness template with a 6-month time window.
2. Analyse metrics: recurring meeting hours, meetings > 60 minutes, multitasking hours.
3. Group by department or business unit to identify hotspots.
4. Calculate potential time savings: if average employee spends 4 hours/week in meetings that could be emails, that's X hours reclaimed per person per week.

**Outcome:** Data-driven recommendations to reclaim meeting time, backed by actual behavioural data rather than surveys.

### Scenario 2: Wellbeing Baseline Before Copilot Rollout

**Template:** Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility

**Goal:** Capture focus time, after-hours work, and work-life balance metrics **before** Copilot deployment. Then compare after 3 months using the Copilot Impact template.

**Approach:**

1. Run the Wellbeing template covering the 4 weeks immediately before Copilot licence assignment — this is the "4-week baseline window" referenced in the Copilot Analytics Implementation Guide.
2. Record baseline metrics: average focus hours, after-hours collaboration hours, weekend work hours.
3. After 3 months of Copilot usage, run the Copilot Impact template for the same population.
4. Compare pre- and post-deployment metrics to quantify Copilot's impact on employee wellbeing.

**Outcome:** Quantifiable evidence of whether Copilot improved, maintained, or negatively affected employee wellbeing metrics.

### Scenario 3: Manager Effectiveness Programme

**Template:** Manager Effectiveness

**Goal:** Identify managers with low 1:1 time or high span of control. Feed insights into leadership development initiatives.

**Approach:**

1. Run the Manager Effectiveness template for the past 6 months.

2. Analyse metrics: manager 1:1 meeting hours, team size (span of control), team after-hours patterns.
3. Filter to managers with fewer than 30 minutes of 1:1 time per direct report per month.
4. Cross-reference with team wellbeing metrics to identify teams with both low manager engagement and high after-hours work.

**Outcome:** Targeted list of managers who would benefit from coaching programmes, with behavioural evidence to support the recommendation.

## 9. Data Retention

Understanding data retention windows is important for planning analysis timeframes and comparing historical trends.

| Data Type | Maximum Retention | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| **Collaboration metrics** (meetings, email, chat, focus time) | Up to 27 months | Starts at 13 months and grows weekly as new data accumulates. Full 27-month window available after ~14 months of active data collection. |
| **Copilot metrics** (adoption, usage, impact, sentiment) | Up to 13 months | Shorter retention window due to newer data collection. Does not extend beyond 13 months. |

**Practical Implication:** Collaboration analysis can look further back in history than Copilot analysis. This means you can establish a rich historical baseline of collaboration patterns — even if Copilot was deployed recently. Use the longer retention window to identify seasonal trends, reorganisation impacts, and long-term cultural shifts.

## 10. References

| Topic | URL |
|---|---|
| Ways of Working Template | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/ways-of-working |
| Meeting Effectiveness Template | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/meeting-effectiveness |
| Wellbeing – Balance & Flexibility Template | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/wellbeing |
| Impact Explorer Template | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/impact-explorer |
| Manager Effectiveness Template | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/templates/manager-effectiveness |
| External Collaboration | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/external-collaboration |
| Metric Definitions | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/reference/metrics |
| Custom Metrics | learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/custom-metrics |

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